

QUOLLS, DUNNARTS, AND RELATIVES

With strong jaws and sharp canine teeth, the family Dasyuridae is made up of more than 70 large and small carnivorous marsupials. These animals also have sharp claws, except on their big toe.



9.5–10.5 cm
3¾–4¼ in

FAT-TAILED FALSE ANTECHINUS

Pseudantechinus macdonnellensis

This nocturnal insect-eater stores fat in the base of its tapered tail. It inhabits arid rocky habitats of C. and W. Australia.

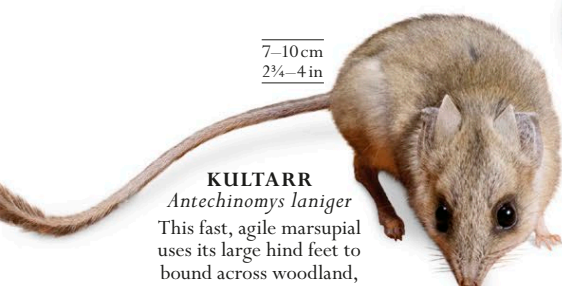


26–40 cm
10–16 in

WESTERN QUOLL

Dasyurus geoffroyi

Also called the chuditch, this nocturnal hunter from S.W. Australia is mainly ground-dwelling, although it can climb trees.



7–10 cm
2¾–4 in

KULTARR

Antechinomys laniger

This fast, agile marsupial uses its large hind feet to bound across woodland, grassland, and semi-desert habitats in southern and C. Australia.



7–14 cm
2¾–5½ in

BROWN ANTECHINUS

Antechinus stuartii

Antechinus males die of stress and exhaustion after their first breeding season. This species is endemic to forests in E. Australia.



19–24 cm
7½–9½ in

THREE-STRIPED DASYURE

Myoictis sp.

This marsupial's coloration helps it to remain camouflaged on the rainforest floor in the islands of Indonesia and New Guinea.



12–23 cm
4¾–9 in

CREST-TAILED MULGARA

Dasyercus cristicauda

This carnivore from W. and C. Australia inhabits arid and semi-arid habitats, such as desert, heath, and grassland. It stores fat in its tail.



5–7.5 cm
2–3 in

RED-TAILED PHASCOGALE

Phascogale calura

Possessing a brush of black hair on its red-based tail, this carnivorous marsupial inhabits woodland in S.W. Australia.



10.5–12.5 cm
4¼–5 in

NARROW-NOSED PLANIGALE

Planigale tenuirostris

This flat-headed, nocturnal, rodent-like marsupial lives in low shrub and dry grassland in S.E. Australia.

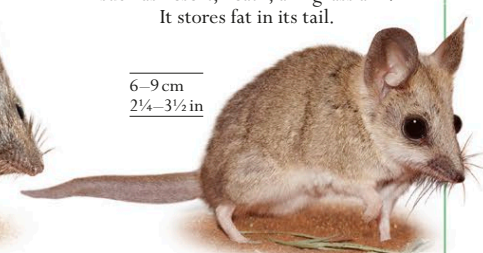


5–7.5 cm
2–3 in

INLAND NINGAUI

Ningaui ridei

A shrew-like marsupial with a pointed snout, this nocturnal predator hunts insects in arid spinifex grassland in C. Australia.

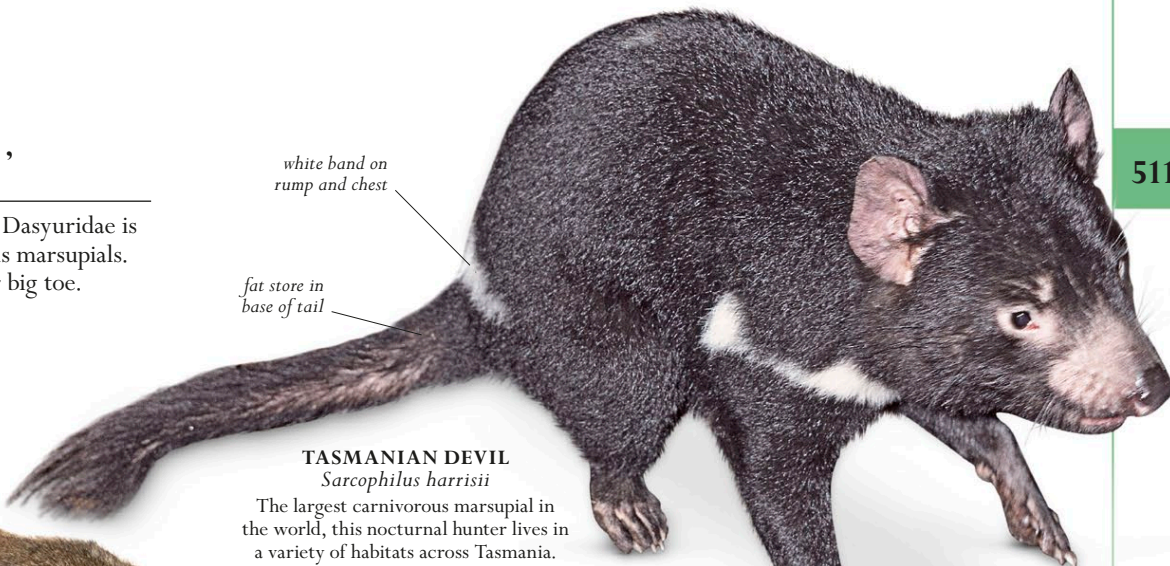


6–9 cm
2¼–3½ in

FAT-TAILED DUNNART

Sminthopsis crassicaudata

Living in open grassland in southern Australia, this small, nocturnal marsupial stores fat reserves in its tail.



white band on rump and chest

fat store in base of tail

TASMANIAN DEVIL

Sarcophilus harrisii

The largest carnivorous marsupial in the world, this nocturnal hunter lives in a variety of habitats across Tasmania.

57–65 cm
22½–26 in

BANDICOOTS

These omnivorous marsupials are found across Australia and New Guinea. Characterized by fused second and third toes on their hind feet and three pairs of lower incisor teeth, the Peramelidae also have short, coarse, or spiny hair.



31–44.5 cm
12–17½ in



22.5–38 cm
9–15 in

SPINY BANDICOOT

Echymipera kalubu

This forest-dwelling, nocturnal insect-eater of New Guinea has a conical snout, spiny coat, and a hairless tail.

melanistic (black) form of species



27–35 cm
10½–14 in

EASTERN BARRED BANDICOOT

Perameles gunnii

Named for the creamy bands of fur on its flanks, this bandicoot lives in grassland and grassy woodland in Australia and Tasmania.



coarse, yellowish brown fur

SOUTHERN BROWN BANDICOOT

Isodon obesulus

This short-nosed bandicoot lives in the shrubby heathland in southern Australia and several islands, including Kangaroo Island and Tasmania.